

Problem Evaluation

1) Consideration of Factors

- ✓ Will it fulfill the organization's goals?
- ✓ Is it solving a critical or pressing problem?
- ✓ How much expertise do we have to work on this problem?
- ✓ What will be the impact of the solution on existing hardware?
- ✓ Will the system achieve any savings or cost avoidances?
- ✓ Can the system be developed in an acceptable amount of time?
- ✓ What is the backlog of work, and how would this request affect it?

2) Analysis of the Request

- ✓ Determine whether the user has identified the real problem or need
- ✓ The analyst must estimate the costs of a detailed study
- ✓ Sources of information when researching any request
 - ✓ The people the system will affect
 - ✓ Organization charts and job descriptions
 - ✓ Related documents

3) Interview. The 5 W Questions

- ✓ **Who** is involved in the situation we are analyzing? What role is played by each of these people? Who will actually be using the proposed software? Will the users be highly trained individuals, computer novices, or both?
- ✓ **What** is the current situation? What is it about the current situation that is posing a problem? What is the proposed system to be? What functions are to be performed by the proposed system?
- ✓ **When** must the new system be in place? When will the changeover to the new system take place? When will the sponsor be ready to install and test the new system on site?
- ✓ **Where** will the new system fit into the old environment? Where will the current personnel fit into the new system?
- ✓ **Why** is a new system being sought? Why do the users believe they need a new system? What is it about the current situation that requires a change to a new system?
- ✓ **How** will the new system function? Are there constraints on how the proposed system can operate? Are there constraints, for ex., on the hardware, the cost of the system, or the programming language to be used?

After the interview, the analyst should summarize the findings in writing, forwarding a copy to the person interviewed.

- ✓ Produces a record of information gained from the interview.
- ✓ Allows those interviewed an opportunity to check for accuracy
- ✓ Permits the analyst to express appreciation formally, which helps maintain rapport between analyst and user

Two disadvantages of the interview

- ✓ The time it takes to schedule
- ✓ The danger of personal bias on the part of either participant

4) Management Action

- ✓ After examining the request and estimating the cost of a detailed analysis, the analyst presents finding to management.
- ✓ Preliminary report usually contains 4 sections :
 - ✓ Problem review
 - ✓ Finding
 - ✓ Recommendations
 - ✓ Cost and schedule estimates.
- ✓ Whenever possible, analysts should pose alternatives so management can weigh the costs and benefits of more than one solution to given problem

5) Client Care Analyst Action

- ✓ Analyze business needs and determine the Client's information requirements independent of technology.
- ✓ Adapt evolving technology to new systems.
- ✓ Keep in mind that, above all, systems exist to support people and organizations that often resist neat, clean technical formulas.

People, not systems, make organizations successful